

Inference - Workbook 2

Practice harder inferences where several answers sound possible.

Strategy reminder

Clues + reasoning = inference. Choose the smallest conclusion that explains the clues. Then verify every important word against the passage.

Early Train

Text 1

Luca usually catches the 8:10 train. On Thursday, he arrived at the station at 7:35 carrying a small suitcase and repeatedly checked the platform display. When the 7:42 express was announced, he moved quickly toward the platform and called someone to say, "I should be there before nine."

1. What can the reader most reasonably infer?

- A. Luca needs to arrive somewhere earlier than on a normal day
- B. Luca has permanently changed jobs
- C. The 8:10 train has been canceled
- D. Luca dislikes express trains

2. Which detail best supports the inference?

- A. Luca usually catches the 8:10 train
- B. He carries a suitcase
- C. He says he should arrive before nine after moving to the 7:42 express
- D. The station has a platform display

The Clean Desk

Text 2

At the end of class, Ms. Lee found a sticky note on her desk listing three tasks: "return lab keys," "email parent forms," and "print tomorrow's quiz." The first two items were crossed out. Beside the printer sat a fresh stack of paper, but no quizzes were in the output tray.

3. What can the reader infer?

- A. Ms. Lee has probably not printed the quiz yet
- B. The quiz has been canceled
- C. The printer is permanently broken
- D. The lab keys were never returned

4. Which evidence is strongest?

- A. There is a desk in the room
- B. Two tasks are crossed out but "print tomorrow's quiz" is not, and the output tray is empty
- C. Paper is white
- D. Class has ended

The Porch Light

Text 3

For several weeks, Elena and her neighbor used a simple arrangement: if the porch light was on at 6:30, the neighbor would bring Elena's dog in from the yard because Elena was working late. One evening the light was off, but the neighbor heard thunder nearby and saw the dog pacing at the gate. He brought the dog inside anyway and left Elena a message.

5. What can be inferred about the neighbor's decision?

- A. He responded to a situation that made the usual signal less important
- B. He forgot the meaning of the porch light
- C. He wanted to keep the dog permanently
- D. Elena had stopped working late forever

6. Which detail best supports that inference?

- A. The porch light was off
- B. The neighbor heard thunder and saw the dog pacing at the gate
- C. The arrangement had lasted several weeks
- D. The message was sent later

Review your reasoning

Before checking the key, mark the question that felt hardest. Write one clue that changed your mind and name the distractor that was most tempting.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A - His earlier arrival, suitcase, quick move to the express, and phone comment all support an earlier-than-usual destination time.

Watch for: Do not turn a one-day change into a permanent life change.

2. C - The timing statement directly links his choice of earlier train to an arrival goal.

Watch for: Use the detail that connects behavior to the inferred reason.

3. A - Two tasks are crossed out, the printing task is not, and no quizzes are present.

Watch for: The best inference explains the pattern without adding a dramatic cause.

4. B - The unfinished list item plus empty output tray directly supports the inference.

Watch for: Pair clues that work together.

5. A - Thunder and the dog's behavior create a reason to act even without the usual signal.

Watch for: A supported inference can explain an exception to a routine.

6. B - Those details explain why the neighbor chose to act despite the missing signal.

Watch for: Find the evidence that explains the decision, not merely the normal rule.